

WRITING SKILLS-II

(PARAGRAPH WRITING)

Paragraph writing involves a number of sub-skills. One has to collect ideas, organize them, and then put them in right order in grammatically correct sentences. One has to make choice of appropriate words, take care of their spellings and also of punctuation to avoid ambiguity. In other words one has to collect ideas, organize them in logical order, draft a piece of composition, edit it and re-draft it. In order to make writing easy for the school students, hints are provided in the form of outlines, pictures, graphs, flow-charts etc.

(a) Describing People

Example :

Mr. M.S. Bedi is my neighbour. He is around 82 years old. He taught as a professor of Mathematics in various government colleges of Punjab before he retired. After his retirement, he did not sit idle and engaged himself in social work, which included teaching the poor students. About a decade ago, in order to help the poor and needy orphans, he sold off his big house situated in a posh locality and moved into a smaller one in another sector. With the money he got by selling his house, he bought a piece of land in a village not very far from the city he lives in. There he set up an orphanage. He approached the sarpanch of that village and with his help he identified some poor boys and brought them with him. Now he looks after them and sends them to a near-by government school to study. He has also opened a dispensary for the villagers who cannot afford expensive treatment. He is also planning to open a vocational centre for training girls in sewing and other skills so that they become independent. People have great respect for him because he has achieved so much in spite of his old age and the handicap-he was struck by polio in his childhood.

Points of remember while writing a paragraph:

1. Collect ideas that are suitable to the topic.
2. Organize ideas in a proper sequence.
3. Use linking words to have continuity of ideas.
4. Write only grammatically correct sentences. Use simple language. Avoid sentences with too many clauses. This may lead to ambiguity.
5. Re-read what you have written. Check spelling and punctuation. Rewrite the paragraph if necessary.

Exercises

- A. Write a paragraph of 10-12 lines taking help of the hints given:

Aruna Asif Ali _____ known as _____ 'Grand Old Lady' _____ Independence movement. Born in orthodox Hindu Bengali family _____ 1909 in _____ place called Kalka. _____ Broke conventions _____ married at 19 _____ Mr. Asif Ali also involved _____ freedom struggle _____ Took part _____ in salt Satyagrah _____ leadership _____ Gandhiji. Addressed public meetings. _____ Led processions. _____ Sentenced to one year imprisonment. _____ Did not give up the cause. _____ went _____ jail again. Later became editor _____ Inquilab. _____ After Independence _____ turned social worker. _____ Fought for rights of women. _____ Received Nehru Award for International Understanding _____ 1992. Died in July 1996. Honoured _____ Bharat Rattna posthumously.

- B. Make use of the information given below and write a paragraph of 10-12 lines on the tribals of Orissa;

Location: Live in forests of Kalahandi _____ in one of the districts of Orissa _____ a backward one.

Description: Dark skin, black hair. Women wear bright coloured saris _____ tuck flowers in their hair. Men wear loin cloth _____ no shirts.

Beliefs of the tribals: Ruled by kings before the Independence _____ Still believe India ruled by kings. Illiterate _____ no schools _____ No modern means of transportation. _____ No motorable roads. _____ Cut off from the world. _____ No idea of currency notes. _____ Still have barter system. Live in groups. _____ Have common property, _____ believe it is common like air and sunshine. Practice black magic-Cure disease with herbs- Set bones by rubbing oils.

The beginning and the end of the paragraph is given below:

There are many tribal groups in Orissa. They live in remote places. One such group lives _____

There should be good government schemes to educate these people to bring them to the main stream.

(b) Describing Places

Example:

The north coastal region of Andhra Pradesh is one of the most beautiful parts of the state. It is known for its golden sand beaches and dense forests. Riverlets, caves, hills, valleys and wildlife offer the tourists an amazing experience. Tyda Jungle Bell Nature Resort situated in this region is worth visiting. This place is located 75km. away from Vishakapatnam on the Araku Road, Tyda. Jungle Bell is the name of the nature camp which is so different from other places. People living in crowded cities come to this place to know about the role nature plays in their lives. They have a very nice time here. Tyda is an ideal place for

watching the wildlife and some rare birds. One can also go rock-climbing, trekking and target-shooting with bow and arrows. Here tourists are also trained to understand the language of birds and animals. If one wants to enjoy nature, Tyda is the right place to visit.

Exercises

A. Write a paragraph on the Golden Temple with the help of the hints given:

Amritsar is also called guru-ki-nagari ---- famous for the Golden Temple---- The temple--- situated in the city----surrounded ---- narrow lanes. The golden shrines, built in the middle of the sarover shines at sunrise and sunset---- Built by Guru Arjan Dev Ji---- It is an experience ---- when ---- Granth Sahib brought out from the Akal Takhat. It---- amidst chanting of hymns and blowing of bugles. ---- The Akal Takhat, facing ---- Harmandir Sahib, built by Guru Hargobind Ji.---- Used for holding courts ever since built ---- The complex has a museum ---- rare paintings, books, shashtras---- Describe lives of the gurus ---- Near Darshani Deori ---- big bazaars ---- sell gutakas, karas and other articles ---- Home made Papad----Varian, chura-bangles and also dry fruit are sold at near-by shops. - --- Mouth-watering sweets and lassi main attractions ----Number of hotels ---- guest houses for tourists to stay -----A sarai for pilgrims ---- worth visiting place.

B. With the help of the information given below, write a paragraph of about 10-12 lines about Canada, the largest country of the world:

Area	:	9 976 139 km
Population	:	32,000,000
Capital	:	Ottawa
Currency	:	Canadian dollar
Language	:	English, French
Climate	:	In winter very cold-some regions (-65°C). Average temperatures in Ottawa ranges from -15°C to -6°C in January and 15 to 26°C in July.
Main products	:	fruit, vegetables, livestock, tobacco, copper, zinc, iron, salt and oil and natural gas.
Major industries	:	agriculture, forestry, food-processing, transport, chemicals, oil and gas refining and cement
Main exports	:	vehicles, machinery, foodstuffs, natural gas, meat, coal and timber

(C) Describing Events/ Incidents

Example:

Pritam Lal is a reckless driver. He always drives very fast. Last week when he was driving round the bend in a hilly area, a herd of sheep came before his truck. Pritam Lal pressed hard on his horn but the sheep did not move. So he moved his steering wheel towards the left to save them. But he lost his balance and struck against a huge rock. Unluckily there was a labourer sitting near the rock. He was badly hurt. So was the cleaner of the truck.

Pritam Lal could not move because the steering wheel pressed hard against his chest. They were all bleeding profusely. There was no one around. After a few minutes, a car drove past and the driver stopped to see what had happened. The owner of the car and his driver managed to get Pritam Lal out of the truck. But he was breathing with great difficulty. He had the other injured people were taken to a near-by hospital. All, including Pritam Lal, are still in hospital. Pritam Lal is battling for his life.

Exercises

A. Write a paragraph with the help of the outline given:

Mr. Ramanathan and his family---out of town. --- Attend a wedding. No one --- home. --
- House --- locked--- Thief broke into house. --- Wife's jewellery, valuables, --- money
stolen --- Neighbour saw lights on --- Informed police. --- Police came along with a dog.
--- Found thief's glove. --- Dog sniffed --- scent --- thief. Policemen took fingerprints. ---
Dog took policeman to--- thief's house. --- Thief had to admit the crime. Burglary solved in
two days. Policemen rewarded.

B. Suppose you were in Mumbai when many people of the city were marooned because of the heavy rainfall in July Write a paragraph of about 10-12 lines about that incident with the help of outline. The beginning and the end of the paragraph are already given:

On July 26, I was busy shopping in a famous crowded market although it was raining. Gradually --- started raining heavily. --- Impossible --- move away --- --- I took shelter --- shop. Soon --- place got flooded --- Water started entering the shops --- . Articles started floating --- Shopkeepers tried to retrieve valuable articles. Failed --- Entire area --- submerged. --- People ---stranded on roads --- vehicles stopped. People stayed on in parked cars, --- others took shelter in houses-shops. It --- risky for school children. --- Suddenly it started raining like hell. People ran for safety. Now water 6-7 feet. People moved to first floor--- shops and houses. In no time the army swung into action--- Volunteers started helping --- with food and water. --- Went on for 24 hours. I cannot forget this horrifying experience.

C. Write a paragraph on 'Lohri' based on the hints provided:

Lohri-festival of fun and frolic --- celebrated --- January which --- peak of winter, --- related to folklore of Dula and Bhatti. People build bonfires---homes or mohallas. --- special arrangements for celebrations --- for a newly married son. Also --- celebrated on a large scale where a son is born. --- Some --- perform Gidha or Bhangra to the beats of the drums. Children form groups---go door to door singing- just like Christians sing hymns during Christmas. --- Collect money-sweets. Lohri a busy festival --- People visit several homes on a single evening.

‘ਸਮਾਜਿਕ ਨਿਆਂ ਅਧਿਕਾਰਤਾ ਅਤੇ ਘੱਟ ਗਿਣਤੀ ਵਿਭਾਗ’, ਪੰਜਾਬ

(d) Describing Procedures

Example:

It is very easy to make a candle. First wax is broken into small pieces. Then water is boiled in a double boiler. Now the wax is put in the top container of the double boiler to melt. It is made to boil to 21°. Care is taken not to over boil it because if heated more it starts smoking. If one wants coloured candles, colour is added at this stage. A wick is inserted inside a mould which is lubricated from inside. It is made sure that the wick does not fall inside the mould by placing a rod across on its top. The wick is tied to it. Now the melted wax is poured into it. The filled mould is put into a bucket containing cold water. The weight is removed and the wax is left to harden over night. Next day the candle is gently pulled out. The candle is ready.

Exercises

A. With the help of the hints given, write a paragraph describing the way in which papier-mache toys are made out of waste paper.

In order to make toys with papier-mache, old newspaper sheets are taken. --- torn into small pieces. ---The pieces -soaked in water overnight. Next day --- mixture boiled for half an hour. ---. Mixture whipped till soft-pulpy. Water squeeze out --- two tablespoon white gum added to the mixture. --- Mixture stirred well. Toys made --- left to dry overnight (or more time---if needed). ---Toys painted --- water-based colour. --- to make them water proof, two or three coats of lacquer given. Masks are also made the same way.

B. Note down the steps for making gajrela :

1. Wash and peel 3kg. carrots
 2. Grate them
 3. Mix 2½ kg milk with the carrots
 4. Put the mixture in a pan and boil it till the mixture is very thick
 5. Add ¾ cup of sugar and 250 gm khoya
 6. Stir the mixture till it becomes thick-stir continuously -- mixture should not stick to the pan
 7. Remove the pan from the fire
 8. Add nuts
 9. Let the gajrela cool
- (Can be served hot also)

Now write procedure mentioned above in the form of a paragraph. Begin like this:

It is very easy to make gajrela at home. Take three kilograms of big size carrots and wash them properly. Then ----